

COMPREHENSIVE UNIVERSITY PROFILE REPORT

University of Maryland, College Park

&

Fairleigh Dickinson University (FDU)

Admissions Criteria • Tuition & Fee Structure (Domestic & International) • Complete Programme Catalogue

Prepared for Kuntesh

July 2026 Edition — compiled from official university sources

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PART A — UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, COLLEGE PARK

1. Institutional Overview

The University of Maryland, College Park (UMD) is a public land-grant research university located in College Park, Maryland, roughly 8 miles from Washington, D.C. It is the flagship institution of the University System of Maryland.

Attribute	Detail
Type	Public research university (land-grant, flagship of University System of Maryland)
Founded	1856
Location	College Park, Maryland (minutes from Washington, D.C.)
Accreditation	Middle States Commission on Higher Education (MSCHE); individual programs accredited by ABET, AACSB, etc.
Total Enrollment	41,000+ students (31,000+ undergraduate; 10,000+ graduate)
Programs Offered	300+ degree programs (90+ undergraduate majors, 200+ graduate/professional programs)
National Ranking	#10 (Forbes Top Colleges); #16 among U.S. public universities (US News & World Report, 2025)
Acceptance Rate	Approx. 44–45% (moderately selective)
Notable Strength Areas	Engineering, Computer Science, Business (Smith School), Public Policy, Journalism, Environmental Science
Academic Calendar	Semester system (Fall and Spring); limited Summer/Winter terms

2. Admission Criteria

2.1 Undergraduate (Freshman) Admission

- Applicants must have completed (or be completing) secondary school / 10+2 with a strong academic record; UMD gives heavy weight to GPA, course rigor, and class rank where available.
- Application platforms: Common Application, Coalition Application, or StandOut Admissions Network.
- UMD is currently test-optional for SAT/ACT through Fall 2027 admissions — scores may be submitted voluntarily.
- Middle 50% profile of admitted students (historical): SAT ~1420 average (Math ~730, Writing/EBRW ~690); ACT ~32 average — placing admits in the top 5–10% nationally.
- Letters of recommendation are considered important; a personal essay/short-answer responses are required through the application platform.

- Early Action deadline: November 1 (Fall intake); Regular Decision: on or around January 20.
- Spring-intake Early Action deadline: August 1 (limited programs only).
- AP credit is recognized; dual-enrollment credit is generally not granted.

2.2 Undergraduate Transfer Admission

- Applicants who have completed 12+ semester hours (or 18+ quarter hours) of college coursework after high school are classified as transfer applicants.
- Students with fewer than 30 semester hours must also submit high school records (and SAT/ACT if chosen).
- A cumulative GPA is computed across all previously attended institutions.
- Early Action deadline for Fall transfer: March 1; Spring transfer: August 1.
- Coursework must come from a regionally accredited institution.

2.3 Graduate (Master's/PhD) Admission

- A bachelor's degree (or equivalent 4-year degree) from a recognized institution with a strong academic record is required.
- GRE/GMAT is optional for most graduate programs, including the Robert H. Smith School of Business MBA and most MS Engineering programs (program-specific exceptions apply — verify with the individual department).
- Statement of purpose, resume/CV, and 2–3 letters of recommendation are typically required.
- Admission is offered via Fall (primary) and Spring (limited, e.g., MS Real Estate Development) intakes.
- Graduate admission is generally considered less competitive than undergraduate admission for well-qualified international applicants.

2.4 International Applicant Requirements (All Levels)

- Non-U.S. citizens / non-permanent residents must meet all standard freshman/transfer/graduate requirements PLUS:
 - English Language Proficiency — one of: IELTS Academic (typically 6.5–7.5 overall depending on program), TOEFL iBT, PTE Academic, or Duolingo English Test (DET).
 - Third-party academic credential evaluation (course-by-course) from an approved agency such as Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE) for all post-secondary credentials — not required for secondary/high-school records.
 - Official transcripts in the original language plus certified English translations.
 - Proof of sufficient financial funding (bank statements/sponsor letters) to cover tuition and living costs, required before an I-20 is issued.
 - Some admitted students may be required to complete English coursework through the Maryland English Institute (MEI) before beginning their degree — this is indicated in the admission decision letter.

- I-20 issuance typically takes 2–4 weeks after financial documentation is submitted.
- Application fee: approximately USD 75 (fee waivers available for eligible students).
- Contact: international-admissions@umd.edu

3. Fee Structure — Official Rates (2026–2027 Academic Year)

Figures below are official published rates from billpay.umd.edu for Fall 2026 & Spring 2027. Rates are set by the University System of Maryland Board of Regents and are subject to change without prior notice.

3.1 Undergraduate Tuition & Mandatory Fees (Per Semester, Full-Time = 12+ credits)

Category	Maryland Resident	Non-Resident (incl. International)
Tuition (per semester)	\$5,507.50	\$21,133.00
Mandatory Fees (9+ credits)	\$910.00	\$910.00
Total Tuition + Fees (per semester)	\$6,417.50	\$22,043.00
Differential Tuition — Jr/Sr in Business, Engineering, Computer Science (added per semester)	+\$1,687.50	+\$1,687.50
Total with Differential (Business/Engg/CS Jr/Sr)	\$8,105.00	\$23,730.50
Per-Credit Rate (Part-Time, 1–11 credits)	\$459.00/credit	\$1,762.00/credit

Annualized (two semesters): Resident full-time ≈ \$12,835 tuition+fees/year; Non-Resident/International full-time ≈ \$44,086 tuition+fees/year (before differential tuition, housing, meals, insurance, and other costs).

3.2 Graduate Tuition & Fees (Per Credit Hour, Fall 2026 & Spring 2027)

Category	Resident	Non-Resident (incl. International)
Tuition (per credit hour)	\$913.00	\$1,916.00
Mandatory Fees (per credit hour, flat)	\$382.50 (9+ cr) / prorated	\$382.50 (9+ cr) / prorated
Total per credit hour	\$1,295.50	\$2,298.50
Example: 10 credits	\$9,868.00	\$19,898.00

Note: Several graduate units (Robert H. Smith School of Business/MBA, School of Public Policy, College of Information Studies, School of Public Health, Telecommunications, MAGE Engineering) charge non-standard, program-specific tuition rates that differ from the base Graduate School rate above — these must be checked on the respective school's website.

3.3 Other Mandatory Charges (All Students)

Fee	Amount
International Student Fee (I-20/DS-2019 issuance)	\$125/semester (\$62.50/term on 12-week calendar programs)
Mandatory Student Health Insurance (SHIP), full year	\$2,939.00 (Fall \$1,232 + Spring \$1,707), unless waived with proof of comparable coverage
Application Fee (Undergraduate)	≈ \$75 (fee waivers available)
Course/Lab Fees	Vary by course, typically \$30–\$60

3.4 Estimated Total Cost of Attendance (Indicative, per Year)

Level	Tuition & Fees Range (USD/year)	Approx. INR Equivalent
Undergraduate	\$41,000 – \$43,000 (Non-Resident/International)	₹38 – 40 Lakh
Graduate (Master's/MBA)	\$22,000 – \$55,000+ depending on program	₹20 – 51 Lakh
MBA (Smith School, all formats)	\$17 – 55 Lakh (INR) first year	₹17 – 55 Lakh
Total Cost of Attendance incl. living (est.)	\$55,000 – \$60,000/year	₹51 – 56 Lakh

Currency conversion approximate (1 USD ≈ ₹92–93 as of early-mid 2026). Cost of attendance includes housing, food, books, transportation, and personal expenses in addition to tuition — for the authoritative current-year budget, consult financialaid.umd.edu.

3.5 Scholarships & Financial Aid

- All applicants (domestic and international) are automatically considered for merit-based scholarships upon admission — no separate scholarship application required.
- Graduate assistantships (teaching/research) are available, often including tuition remission plus stipend, though they are competitive and vary by department.
- Need-based aid is limited for international students; external funding (e.g., Fulbright) may be pursued separately.
- Notable named awards include the Engineering Excellence Award and Terp Talent Grant (merit/talent-based, program-specific).

4. Complete List of Programs / Courses

UMD offers 300+ degree programs across 12 schools and colleges. A representative, detailed listing by discipline area follows.

4.1 Undergraduate Programs (Representative — 90+ Majors Offered)

School/College	Sample Undergraduate Majors
A. James Clark School of Engineering	Aerospace Engineering, Bioengineering, Chemical Engineering, Civil & Environmental Engineering, Computer Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Fire Protection Engineering, Materials Science & Engineering, Mechanical Engineering
College of Computer, Mathematical & Natural Sciences (CMNS)	Computer Science, Mathematics, Statistics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Astronomy, Atmospheric & Oceanic Science, Data Science
Robert H. Smith School of Business	Accounting, Finance, Marketing, Management, Supply Chain Management, Operations Management & Business Analytics, Information Systems
College of Arts & Humanities	English, History, Philosophy, Art, Art History, Theatre, Music, Communication, Languages (Spanish, French, Chinese, Arabic, etc.)
College of Behavioral & Social Sciences	Psychology, Economics, Government & Politics, Criminology & Criminal Justice, Sociology, Geography, Anthropology
Philip Merrill College of Journalism	Journalism (Broadcast, Multi-Platform)
College of Information Studies	Information Science
School of Public Policy	Public Policy (undergraduate track)
College of Agriculture & Natural Resources	Environmental Science & Policy, Agricultural & Resource Economics, Animal Sciences, Plant Sciences, Nutrition & Food Science
School of Architecture, Planning & Preservation	Architecture (pre-professional)
College of Education	Early Childhood/Elementary Education, Secondary Education, Kinesiology
School of Public Health	Public Health Science, Kinesiology, Family Science

4.2 Graduate Programs (Representative — 200+ Programs)

Discipline Area	Representative Master's / Doctoral Programs
Engineering	MEng/MS/PhD in Aerospace, Bioengineering, Chemical, Civil, Electrical & Computer, Fire Protection, Materials Science, Mechanical, Systems Engineering; Maryland Applied Graduate Engineering (MAGE)
Computer & Data Sciences	MS Computer Science, MS Data Science, MS Information Systems, MS Business Analytics (Smith), MS Machine Learning, PhD Computer Science
Business (Smith School)	Full-Time MBA, Flex MBA, Executive MBA, Online MBA, MS Business Analytics, MS Finance, MS Marketing Analytics, MS Information Systems, PhD Business & Management
Public Policy & Public Affairs	Master of Public Policy (MPP), Master of Public Management, PhD Public Policy

Discipline Area	Representative Master's / Doctoral Programs
Public Health	MPH, MS Kinesiology, PhD Public Health Sciences
Journalism & Communication	MJ (Master of Journalism), MA Communication
Information Studies	MLIS (Library & Information Science), MS Information Management, PhD Information Studies
Sciences	MS/PhD Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Mathematics, Statistics, Atmospheric & Oceanic Science, Astronomy
Social Sciences	MA/PhD Economics, Psychology, Sociology, Government & Politics, Criminology
Architecture & Real Estate	Master of Architecture, Master of Real Estate Development (MRED — Spring intake available)
Education	M.Ed., Ed.D., PhD in various specializations
Telecommunications	MS Telecommunications (2-year program, joint engineering/business curriculum)
Survey Methodology	MS/PhD Survey Methodology (Joint Program in Survey Methodology — JPSM)

Popular programs among international students specifically include MS Data Science, MS Information Systems, MS Business Analytics, the MBA, and MS Mechanical Engineering.

5. Application Deadlines Snapshot

Applicant Type	Fall Intake Deadline	Spring Intake Deadline
Undergraduate Freshman (Early Action)	November 1	August 1
Undergraduate Regular Decision	≈ January 20	—
Undergraduate Transfer (Early Action)	March 1	August 1
Graduate Programs	Varies by department (many Dec–Feb)	Varies by program (limited)

International applicants are strongly advised to apply by early-action deadlines to allow sufficient time for visa processing (F-1/DS-160, SEVIS fee, embassy interview).

PART B — FAIRLEIGH DICKINSON UNIVERSITY (FDU)

1. Institutional Overview

Attribute	Detail
Type	Private, not-for-profit, non-sectarian, multi-campus university
Founded	1942
Campuses	Florham Campus (Madison, NJ), Metropolitan Campus (Teaneck/Hackensack, NJ), Vancouver Campus (Canada), Wroxtton College (England)
Accreditation	Middle States Commission on Higher Education (MSCHE); AACSB-accredited business school (Silberman College)
Total Enrollment	12,000+ students from 32+ U.S. states and 70+ countries
International Student Body	1,100+ international students from 70+ countries — one of the largest international cohorts among U.S. peer institutions
Programs Offered	100+ undergraduate and graduate programs, including doctoral programs
Acceptance Rate	≈ 87–92% (considered accessible/less selective)
Class Size / Ratio	Average class size ~17 students; student-to-faculty ratio ~15:1
Notable Strength Areas	Nursing (MSN/DNP), Clinical & School Psychology (PsyD), Pharmacy, Part-Time MBA, Public Affairs, Business (Silberman College — AACSB)
Graduate Employment Outcomes	Undergraduate placement rate ≈ 97% within 6 months of graduation; alumni at firms including ADP, Barclays, Goldman Sachs, Deloitte, BASF
Recognition	Ranked #14, Best Value Schools (North) — U.S. News & World Report

2. Admission Criteria

2.1 Undergraduate (Freshman) Admission

- Application via the FDU International Application Portal or the Common Application.
- Minimum GPA guideline: approximately 3.0 (varies by program; holistic review of academic record, personality, and potential is applied).
- Required documents: official secondary school transcripts (with certified English translation if applicable), Statement of Purpose, resume, and typically two letters of recommendation.
- Standardized tests (SAT/ACT) are generally not mandatory; admission is based primarily on academic record.

- Admissions are offered on a rolling basis, though early submission is recommended for scholarship consideration and visa timing.
- Application fee: \$50 (per FDU's official Florham/Metropolitan tuition schedule).

2.2 Graduate Admission

- A bachelor's degree from a recognized institution is required; a 3-year bachelor's degree (as awarded in some countries, including India) is accepted by many departments.
- GRE/GMAT is required only for select programs (e.g., certain MBA and specialized master's tracks); several graduate programs — such as the Master of Sport Management (MSM) — waive the test requirement entirely.
- Required documents: official transcripts translated into English, Statement of Purpose, resume/CV, and letters of recommendation.
- Application processing typically takes 3–4 weeks once the application is complete.
- Application fee for international graduate applicants: approximately \$50–\$100 depending on program.

2.3 International Applicant Requirements (All Levels)

- English Language Proficiency (non-native English speakers): TOEFL iBT, IELTS Academic, PTE Academic, or Duolingo English Test — minimum scores vary by program.
- Applicants who do not meet the English threshold may still be admitted conditionally through FDU's pathway programs, with additional English coursework.
- A bank statement demonstrating sufficient funds to cover at least the first year's tuition and living expenses is required for visa document (I-20/DS-2019) issuance.
- All non-English transcripts must include certified English translations.
- F-1 or J-1 student visa required; visa document issued once financial documentation is verified.
- A limited number of majors are not available to international students on the New Jersey campuses — applicants should verify programme availability before applying.
- Fall Intake application deadline (UG & PG international): on or around June 1 (rolling admissions generally continue beyond this where space allows).

3. Fee Structure — Official Rates (2026–2027 Academic Year, Florham Campus)

Figures below are official published rates for the Florham Campus (fdu.edu/admissions/tuition-fees). Metropolitan Campus and Vancouver Campus rates differ slightly — consult the respective campus tuition pages. All charges are subject to change at the discretion of FDU's Board of Trustees.

3.1 Undergraduate Tuition & Fees

Category	Rate
Full-Time Tuition (flat rate, 12–18 credits/semester)	\$38,600 per academic year

Category	Rate
Part-Time Tuition (per credit)	\$1,120.00/credit
Technology Fee	\$1,080.00/year
University Wellness Fee	\$140.00/year
New Student Fee (international students, new freshmen & transfers — one-time, non-refundable)	\$900.00
Graduation Fee	\$280.00
Health & Major Medical Insurance (full year — domestic or international; waivable with proof of alternate coverage)	\$1,934.00
OPT Service Fee (for post-completion work authorization)	\$500.00
Application Fee	\$50.00 (non-refundable)

3.2 Estimated Total Cost of Attendance — Undergraduate (Florham Campus, per year)

Cost Component	On-Campus Resident	Commuter	Off-Campus
Tuition (12–18 credits)	\$38,600	\$38,600	\$38,600
Standard Fees (tech, wellness, new-student fee)	\$2,120	\$2,120	\$2,120
Housing	\$10,976	\$1,252	\$16,182
Meals	\$6,118	\$4,070	\$6,256
Books & Supplies	\$1,290	\$1,290	\$1,290
Transportation	\$732	\$3,658	\$3,658
Miscellaneous / Personal	\$3,052	\$3,052	\$3,052
TOTAL COST OF ATTENDANCE	\$62,888	\$54,042	\$71,158

3.3 Graduate Tuition (Indicative, by Programme Type)

Programme	Approx. First-Year Tuition (USD)	Approx. First-Year Tuition (INR)
MS (various STEM/Business specializations, 18–24 months)	\$12,700 – \$39,000	₹11.8 – 36.1 Lakh
MBA / PGDM (2–3 years)	\$18,400 – \$24,300	₹17.1 – 22.5 Lakh
LL.M.	Program-specific — consult FDU School of Law-affiliated listings	
Overall Graduate Range (all programs)	\$6,900 – \$44,500	₹5.9 – 37.9 Lakh

Graduate tuition is generally billed per credit hour; consult fdu.edu/admissions/tuition-fees/graduate-tuition-fees/ for current per-credit rates by college (Silberman College of Business, Becton College of Arts & Sciences, School of Pharmacy, School of Public & Global Affairs, School of Nursing, etc.).

3.4 Undergraduate Programme-Specific First-Year Fee Snapshot (International Students)

Programme	Duration	1st-Year Tuition (approx.)
B.E./B.Tech.	4 years	₹33.4 Lakh
Other UG Bachelor's Degrees	3 years	₹33.4 Lakh
BBA	3 years	₹33.4 Lakh
BDS	7 years	₹30.5 – 33.4 Lakh

3.5 Scholarships & Financial Aid

Scholarship / Grant	Approx. Value	Key Conditions
Merit-Based Scholarships (International Undergraduate)	Varies by academic profile	Automatically considered upon admission — no separate application required
FDU Family Grant	\$1,500/year (up to 4 years, UG)	For households with 2+ dependent children enrolled at FDU simultaneously
Children of Alumni Grant	\$1,500/year (renewable, UG)	For dependents of FDU graduates
Athletic Scholarships	Up to full tuition + housing	NCAA Division I recognition — Metropolitan Campus only

4. Complete List of Programs / Courses

FDU offers 100+ undergraduate and graduate programs, delivered primarily through Becton College of Arts & Sciences and Silberman College of Business, along with the School of Pharmacy, School of Nursing, School of Public & Global Affairs, and School of Psychology & Counseling.

4.1 Undergraduate Programs (Representative)

College/School	Sample Undergraduate Majors/Programs
Becton College of Arts & Sciences	Biology, Chemistry, Psychology, Communication Studies, English, Political Science, Criminal Justice, Environmental Science, Allied Health Technology, Radiography (AS)

College/School	Sample Undergraduate Majors/Programs
Silberman College of Business (AACSB-accredited)	Accounting, Finance, Marketing, Management, International Business, Entrepreneurship, Supply Chain Management, Cyber Security & Information Systems
School of Pharmacy & Health Sciences	Pre-Pharmacy pathway to Pharm.D., Medical Technology (BS)
School of Nursing	BS Nursing (traditional & accelerated pathways)
School of Computer Science & Engineering	Computer Science, Cybersecurity, Software Engineering, Applied Data Science
School of the Arts / Communication	Digital Journalism & Media, Film, Graphic Design, Performing Arts
COMPASS Program (Becton College)	Individualized support program for select students with learning differences (additional program fee applies)

4.2 Graduate Programs (Representative)

Discipline Area	Representative Graduate Programs
Business (Silberman College — AACSB-accredited)	MBA (Full-Time, Part-Time & Online), MS Accounting, MS Finance, MS International Business, MS Information Technology, MS Management Information Systems
Nursing	MSN (Master of Science in Nursing), DNP (Doctor of Nursing Practice), Post-Master's Certificates
Psychology & Counseling	PsyD (Clinical Psychology), PsyD (School Psychology), MA Counseling Psychology, MA Forensic Psychology
Pharmacy	Pharm.D. (Doctor of Pharmacy)
Public & Global Affairs	MA International Studies, MPA (Public Administration), MA Homeland Security
Computer Science & Data	MS Computer Science, MS Data Science, MS Cybersecurity
Education	M.A.T. (Master of Arts in Teaching), Ed.D.
Sport Management	MSM (Master of Sport Management — test-optional)
Hospitality & Tourism	MS Hospitality Management
Law-adjacent / Public Affairs	LL.M. offerings (verify current availability with School of Public & Global Affairs)

The most in-demand graduate degrees at FDU are widely cited as the MSN/DNP (Nursing), Part-Time MBA, PsyD (Clinical/School Psychology), Pharm.D., and MPA (Public Affairs).

5. Application Deadlines & Process Snapshot

Step	Detail
Application Submission	Rolling admissions; Fall Intake international deadline ≈ June 1
Processing Time	3–4 weeks after a complete application is received
Decision Communication	Offer or rejection communicated via email
Visa Documentation	I-20/DS-2019 issued after financial documents are received and verified
Enrollment Deposit	Required to confirm seat after offer acceptance (amount is program-specific)

PART C — SIDE-BY-SIDE COMPARISON

Parameter	University of Maryland, College Park	Fairleigh Dickinson University
Institution Type	Public research university	Private, not-for-profit university
Founded	1856	1942
Acceptance Rate	≈ 44–45% (selective)	≈ 87–92% (accessible)
Total Enrollment	41,000+	12,000+
International Students	Significant, competitive intake	1,100+ from 70+ countries (large relative share)
Ranking Signal	#10 Forbes Top Colleges; #16 US public universities (US News 2025)	#14 Best Value Schools, North (US News)
Undergrad Tuition (Non-Resident/Intl, per year, tuition+fees only)	≈ \$44,086	\$38,600 (flat) + \$2,120 fees ≈ \$40,720
Estimated Total UG Cost of Attendance/year	\$55,000 – \$60,000+	\$54,000 – \$71,000 (housing-dependent)
Graduate Tuition (per credit, non-resident)	\$1,916 (base rate; varies by school)	Varies by college — typically \$700–\$1,300/credit depending on program
GRE/GMAT Policy	Optional for most programs	Required only for select programs
SAT/ACT Policy (UG)	Test-optional through Fall 2027	Generally not required
Standout Strength	Engineering, CS, Business, Public Policy, Proximity to D.C.	Nursing, Clinical Psychology (PsyD), Pharmacy, Business (AACSB)
Campus Locations	Single primary campus (College Park, MD)	4 campuses (Florham & Metropolitan NJ, Vancouver, Wroxtton England)

Important Disclaimer

All figures in this report reflect officially published rates and publicly available admissions data as of July 2026 (University of Maryland: billpay.umd.edu, admissions.umd.edu, academiccatalog.umd.edu; Fairleigh Dickinson University: fdi.edu/admissions). Tuition, fees, scholarship terms, and admission requirements are set by each university's governing board and are revised annually — figures should be independently verified on the official university websites (umd.edu and fdi.edu) before making application or financial decisions. Currency conversions to INR are approximate and fluctuate with exchange rates.